

DANIELLE SCHMIDT-LARIOS

University of Wisconsin – Madison, Community & Environmental Sociology
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Formal Education

Exp. 2027 PhD, Sociology/Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison

Dissertation: Spatiotemporalities of Agricultural Land Loss

Committee: Katherine J. Curtis (chair) – Community & Environmental Sociology
Tessa Conroy – Ag & Applied Economics/Extension Specialist
Sarah Rios – Environmental Studies, Cal Poly Humboldt

Prelim. Exams: Environmental Sociology (passed with distinction)
Sociology of Agrifood Systems

Minor: Geography

2023 MS, Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison

Thesis: Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Understanding the decision-making processes of agricultural landholders in the Upper Missouri River Breaks

2019 AB, Philosophy, Public Policy Studies (honors), The University of Chicago

Minor: Human Rights

Research & Teaching Interests

Rural sociology; environmental sociology; mixed-methods; spatial analysis; deep mapping; ethnography; oral histories; land tenure; agricultural labor; rural livability

Refereed Publications

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. 2026. “Land through three approaches.” *Agriculture and Human Values*, 43(1). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10460-026-10853-1>.

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. “Prosperity Across the United States: Revisiting the Isserman, Feser, and Warren Prosperity Index Using Sequence Analysis.” *International Regional Science Review* 49 (2): 147–78. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01600176251377424>.

Schmidt, Danielle. 2024. “Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Senses of Place and Land Sale Decision-Making in the Northern Great Plains.” *Rural Sociology*, 89(4), 975-995. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ruso.12574>.

Schmidt, Danielle and Séamus A. Power. 2020. “Offline World: The Internet as Social Infrastructure among the Unconnected in Quasi-Rural Illinois.” *Integrative Psychological and Behavioral Science*, 55(2), 371-385. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12124-020-09574-9>.

Book Chapters & Reviews

Boyce, Mckenzie, Yang Cheng, Erin Gaede, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. 2027. "Measuring Rural Livability: Challenges, Choices, and Considerations." In *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*, edited by Tessa Conroy and Steven Deller. Community Development Series, Routledge. [In press]

Schmidt, Danielle. 2023. "Farming for sociologists: A new key text for rural sociologists." *Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, and Community Development*, 12(4), 1–2.
<https://doi.org/10.5304/jafscd.2023.124.004>

Outreach & Public Scholarship

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. (2026). *WIndicator: Sharing Livability: Assessing the Link Between Rural and Urban Prosperity* [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. <https://doi.org/10.21231/mwem-5533>

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller (2025). "Pathways to Prosperity: Moving Beyond Growth to Evaluate Change in Community Well-Being." *Choices Magazine* 40 (2).
<https://www.choicesmagazine.org/choices-magazine/submitted-articles/pathways-to-prosperity-moving-beyond-growth-to-evaluate-change-in-community-well-being> [peer reviewed]

Schmidt, Danielle, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. (2025). *WIndicator: Understanding Wisconsin prosperity in the national context* [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. <https://doi.org/10.21231/BRBW-6V80>

Curtis, Katherine J., **Danielle D. Schmidt**, and John C. Canfield. "Views on the Land." *Phillips County News*, May 22, 2024. <https://www.phillipscountynews.com/story/2024/05/22/opinion/views-on-the-land/15471.html>

Rios, Sarah and **Danielle Schmidt** (2023). "Survey Summary: A summary of farmworker responses to experiencing wildfires in the workplace." Prepared for *Lideres Campesinas en California*.
<https://liderescampesinas.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/F.I.R.E-Report-1030-.pdf>

Schmidt, Danielle. "Letter: Tyson the Bison and the Future of Farming." *Daily Herald*, May 14, 2022.
<https://www.dailyherald.com/discuss/20220514/letter-tyson-the-bison-and-the-future-of-farming>

Curtis, Katherine J., John C. Canfield, and **Danielle D. Schmidt** (2021). "A Report on Population and Ag Production in Phillips County, Montana." <https://apl.wisc.edu/shared/conservation-agriculture-rural/phillips-county>

Manuscripts in Progress

Under review

Boyce, Mckenzie, **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**, Erin Gaede, and Yang Cheng. "The Community Capitals for Quantitative Research: Data, Directions, and Debates," *Journal of Rural Studies* (Revise and Resubmit, July 2026)

Schmidt, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. "Leaving 'Cowboy Ethnography' in the Dust and Advancing the Practice of Collaborative Ethnography," *Sociological Methods and Research* (First submit, April 2026)

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios. "Wildfires in the Workplace: A Survey of Latinx Farmworkers," *Journal of Agromedicine* (First submit, July 2026)

In preparation

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, and Tessa Conroy. “Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local quality of life”

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Amanda McMillan Lequeieu, and Katherine J. Curtis. 2027. “Home in a Changing Climate” [Invited by the International Sociological Association]

Boyce, Mckenzie, Tessa Conroy, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. “Pulling Back the Curtain: How Measurement Decisions Shape Narratives of Livability”

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. “Former Farms: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era”

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains”

Book Manuscript

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. *Reserved for whom? (Re)Making Home, Place, and Identity on Rural Landscapes*

Research, Teaching, & Service Awards

May 2026	John Harrison Kolb Memorial Scholarship Award for <i>exceptional intellectual contributions, academic achievements, and professional involvement</i> , Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison
Apr. 2026	Calvin L. Beale Graduate Award for <i>perpetuating the belief that understanding the people behind the statistics is the very essence of sociological research</i> , Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison
Mar. 2025	Ronald Wimberley Graduate Student Paper Competition for <i>making a strong contribution to our understanding of rural community life and health</i> , Community, Health, and Family Research Interest Group, Rural Sociological Society
Nov. 2023	Honored Instructor for <i>positive impact on students</i> , University Housing (student nominated), UW-Madison
Jun. 2019	Richard P. Taub Prize for <i>best thesis</i> , Dept. of Public Policy, The University of Chicago
Nov. 2018	Abraham Lincoln Civic Engagement Award for <i>leadership and service in the pursuit of the betterment of humanity</i> , UChicago Recipient, The Lincoln Academy of Illinois

Competitive Funding & Research Grants

May 2026	PI: Grad Student “Small Grant” Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, \$390
May 2025	PI: Summer Mini-Grant , Center for Integrated Agricultural Systems (CIAS), \$2,991.80
Mar. 2025	PI: Dissertation Research Award, Rural Sociological Society, \$2,800
May 2024	PI: Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Pre-Dissertation Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, \$2,585
May 2022	PI: Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Master’s Thesis Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, \$5,000
Mar. 2022	PI: Grad Student “Small Grant” Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, \$165

Formal Research Positions

Appointments

- 2024 - Graduate Research Assistant, UW-Madison Agriculture & Applied Economics
Wisconsin Rural Partnership Initiative: [The Rural Livability Project](#)
Professor Tessa Conroy, Primary Investigator
- 2021-23 Graduate Research Assistant, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology
Crisis and Adaptation: How Wildfires Change the Agricultural Workplace
Professor Sarah M. Rios, Primary Investigator
- 2020-21 State Research Assistantship, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology
[Conflict at the Intersection of Production and Conservation](#)
Professor Katherine J. Curtis, Supervisor

Contracts

- Spring 2026 GIS data visualization, Economic impact of hospitals on the Wisconsin economy
Professor Steven Deller (Emeritus, UW-Madison)
- Spring 2025 Qualitative data collection, Rural Informal Work in economically, socially, culturally, and technologically changing contexts
Professor Emily Wornell (Ball State), Primary Investigator; Professors Amanda McMillan Lequieu (Drexel) and Jean Hardy (Michigan State), Supervisors

Formal Teaching Positions

- Fall 2023 TA, SOC 125: *American Society: How It Really Works*, UW-Madison Dept of Sociology
- Spring 2023 TA, ILS 200: *Critical Thinking & Expression*, UW-Madison Integrated Liberal Studies

Professional Experience

- 2019-20 Strategic Futures Analyst, Arizona Commerce Authority Phoenix, AZ
- 2018-19 Charity Management Consultant, The Giving Back Fund Los Angeles, CA

Invited Presentations

Research

- Sep. 2026 “Deep Mapping Change in Human-Land Relations on the Northern Great Plains,” Symposium of the National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH) Community Deep Mapping Institute (CDMI), held in Sumter, South Carolina
- Apr. 2026 “Reserved: The transition of production agricultural land to conservation reserves across two cases,” Michigan Technological University Dept. of Social Sciences, held in Houghton, MI
- Oct. 2025 “Cowboy Ethnography: Challenges of and strategies for collaborative spatial data collection and community engaged methods in the twenty-first century,” American Philosophical Society International Symposium on the Future of Fieldwork, held in Philadelphia, PA ([view recording here](#))

Outreach/Extension

- Jun. 2025 “What Makes a Place ‘Livable’?” Connecting Entrepreneurial Communities, held in Wisconsin Rapids, WI (view presentation slides [here](#))

Guest Lectures

- Nov. 2025 “Reserved for whom?” *Conservation Biology*, Williams College
- Oct. 2025 “Reserved for whom?” *Environment, Natural Resources, and Society*, UW-Madison

Conference Presentations

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- Nov. 2026 “Constructing the Myth of the Wilderness: Examining the sociopolitical process of creating conservation reserves,” Social Science History Association; Atlanta, GA
- Aug. 2026 “Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local livability,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
- Aug. 2026 “Negotiating Salvation: Conflict in Conservation,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
- Nov. 2025 “Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data,” North American Regional Science Council Annual Meeting; Denver, CO
- Jul. 2025 “Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
- Jul. 2025 “The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
- Jul. 2025 “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” International Sociological Association; Rabat, Morocco
- Mar. 2025 “The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface,” American Association of Geographers; Detroit, MI
- Jul. 2024 “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Madison, WI
- Nov. 2023 “Wildfires in the Workplace: Understanding the manufactured precarity of farm work in a changing climate,” Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Washington, D.C.
- Apr. 2023 “Pricing the Prairie: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community,” Population Assoc. of America; New Orleans, LA
- Nov. 2022 “A Done Deed: The Socially Contentious Decision to Sell Production Land,” Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Chicago, IL
- Jul. 2021 “‘Save the Cowboy’: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Virtual

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

Rural Sociological Society; Social Science History Association; American Association of Geographers

Service to Department & Profession

Committee

Jan. 2026	Member, Awards and Endowment Committee, Rural Sociological Society
2023-25	Co-Chair, Rural, Ag, and Environmental Network, Social Science History Association
2023	Organizing Committee, UW Agroecology Symposium: “Relationships for Change”
2022	Graduate Student Rep., Ethics Committee, Rural Sociological Society
2020-22	Member, Culture & Climate Committee, UW-Madison Sociology Grad Student Assoc.

Teaching/Mentoring in the Academy and Community

2026 -	Supervisor, Undergraduate Research Assistant for the Rural Livability Project
Mar. 2026	Capstone Project “Expert,” Dept. of Agriculture and Applied Economics, UW-Madison
Mar. 2025	Capstone Project “Expert,” Dept. of Agriculture and Applied Economics, UW-Madison
2024-25	ESL Instructor (Adult Education), Madison International Partners
2024 -	Research Mentor, AP Capstone Research, Mentor Matching Engine
2020 -	Executive Board Member, Mundelein High School Foundation

Referee

Jul. 2026	Reviewer, <i>The International Journal of Sociology of Agriculture and Food</i>
Jun. 2026	Reviewer, <i>Agriculture and Human Values</i>
Apr. 2026	Reviewer, <i>Review of Regional Studies</i>
Mar. 2026	Reviewer, <i>Agriculture and Human Values</i>
Feb. 2026	Reviewer, <i>Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability</i>
Jan. 2026	Pre-proposal Reviewer, North Central Sustainable Agriculture and Research Education

Technical Skills

Software:	R, ArcGIS (Pro, StoryMaps), Qualtrics, NVivo
Languages:	English (native), Spanish (limited working proficiency)
Certifications:	(Farmer-oriented) Mental Health First Aid

References

Katherine J. Curtis

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